Check your website yourself, ***step by step***

Your website should help people find you, trust you, and get in touch. This guide walks you through the same checks as my free website check, with simple ways to test each one yourself. Set aside about 30 minutes.

1 Before you start

- [ ] Your phone, using mobile data instead of Wi-Fi
- [ ] A friend who doesn't know your business well
- [ ] A computer with a web browser
- [ ] A notepad to list what you find

2 The phone test

Most visitors arrive on a phone, so start there. Open your site on your phone and check each page.

- [ ] **Easy to read:** text is readable without zooming, and nothing slides sideways off the screen.
- [ ] **Easy to tap:** buttons and links are big enough to tap with a thumb, and the menu opens and closes.
- [ ] **Quick to load:** each page shows up in about 3 seconds. For a second opinion, enter your address at pagespeed.web.dev (Google's free speed test) and look at the mobile score. Large photos are the most common cause of slow pages.
- [ ] **Tap to call:** tapping your phone number starts a call, and tapping your email opens a new message.

3 The 5-second test

Show your home page to your friend for 5 seconds, then ask what you do, who you serve, and where.

- [ ] **Clear message:** if they can't answer, say it plainly in the first line people see.
- [ ] **Clear next step:** every page has one main button, like call, book, buy, or donate.
- [ ] **Contact details:** phone, email, hours, and location are in the footer and on a contact page, written as text, not only inside a photo or PDF.

4 Can people find you?

- [ ] **Your name:** search your business name on Google. Your site should be at or near the top.
- [ ] **What you do:** search what you do plus your town, the way a new customer would. Note who shows up.
- [ ] **Your pages:** search site:yourbusiness.com (with your own address) to see which pages Google knows about.
- [ ] **Page titles:** each page has its own title in the browser tab that says what's on it, not just "Home".
- [ ] **Google Business Profile:** claimed, up to date, and linking to your website. My free Google profile check covers this step by step.
- [ ] **Search Console:** Google's free Search Console shows what people search to find you and any problems Google sees.

5 Trust and upkeep

- [ ] Real reviews, quotes, or photos of your work
- [ ] Your address starts with https and shows a lock
- [ ] Your contact form works: send yourself a test
- [ ] No old events, prices, staff, or dates
- [ ] Every link works, with no error pages
- [ ] Visitor stats show how many people visit and contact you

6 What to fix first

Start with anything broken, like a form, link, or phone number, since it costs you customers today. Then fix the phone experience, your message and next step, and your contact details. Speed, search, and the rest can follow.

Rather have me look?

I'm Alexandria Cuellar, and I run Auva Studio, a digital technology and solutions studio in the Hudson Valley.

- **Website Diagnostic, $199:** I review your site on a phone and a computer, run it through Google's own tools, and send a plain-English report with your fixes in order, within 5 business days.

The $199 is credited toward a new website with me.

Take the free check at auvastudio.com/website-check, or email hello@auvastudio.com

Free tools and their screens change from time to time, so a button may have a slightly different name than the one here.